

C483

Principles of Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A warehouse manager, who has an engineering degree and a long commute, compares this month's order-accuracy rate of 94% with the 98% standard and schedules retraining for the pickers whose errors caused the gap. Which management function is she performing?

- A. Leading, because retraining involves people.
- B. Controlling.
- C. Organizing.
- D. Planning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A new clinic director decides the clinic will cut average patient wait times to 15 minutes by year-end and outlines the steps to get there. Which function is this?

- A. Leading.
- B. Planning.
- C. Organizing.
- D. Controlling.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A regional sales director who has won three company awards tells her team that the firm must shift from selling products to selling long-term service partnerships. She paints a picture of what that future looks like and rallies the team around it. She keeps a plant on her desk. What is she mainly doing?

- A. Leading.
- B. Managing.
- C. Leading, because she holds a director title.
- D. Controlling.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

The marketing department of a national grocery chain, after a well-attended offsite at a lake resort, writes a one-year plan to raise its store-brand share, including a quarterly campaign calendar tied to the CEO's five-year growth strategy. What level of plan is this?

- A. Strategic.
- B. Strategic, because it is important to the company.
- C. Tactical.
- D. Operational.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A furniture factory with a new showroom finds that 6% of its chairs have loose joints at final inspection. The plant manager, who was hired from a rival last year, is considering options. Which option best reflects total quality management?

- A. Hire more final inspectors.
- B. Form a team of line workers to find the root cause and improve the gluing step through Plan-Do-Check-Act.
- C. Redesign the showroom to highlight other products.
- D. Accept 6% as normal for the industry.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

An engineer at a fast-growing aerospace firm with a campus in Colorado reports to the engineering department head for technical work and to a project manager for a satellite contract. The firm recently opened a cafeteria. What structure is this?

- A. Functional.
- B. Divisional.
- C. Flat structure.
- D. Matrix.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A consumer-goods company reorganizes into three units — Beverages, Snacks, and Personal Care — each with its own marketing, operations, and finance staff. What structure is this?

- A.** Functional structure.
- B.** Matrix structure.
- C.** Network structure.
- D.** Divisional (product) structure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A call center with 64 frontline agents, a new phone system, and a top customer-satisfaction score plans a hierarchy in which every manager has exactly 4 direct reports, up to a single director. How many managers, including the director, will it need?

- A.** 9
- B.** 16
- C.** 21
- D.** 256

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company wants fewer management layers without changing headcount. What should it do to span of control?

- A.** Narrow it, so each manager supervises fewer people.
- B.** Keep it the same and add a matrix.
- C.** Widen it, so each manager supervises more people.
- D.** Eliminate all managers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A regional bank known for its community programs hired 50 of 100 applicants from Group A and 12 of 40 applicants from Group B for teller jobs. The hiring manager says the test is neutral and was bought from a respected vendor. Is there evidence of adverse impact under the four-fifths rule?

- A.** No; the gap is only 20 percentage points.
- B.** No; the test is neutral and from a respected vendor.
- C.** Yes, simply because 12 is less than 50.
- D.** Yes; the ratio of selection rates is 0.60, below 0.80.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A firm hires 60% of applicants from its highest-selected group. Under the four-fifths rule, what is the lowest selection rate another group can have without indicating adverse impact?

- A.** 48%
- B.** 75%
- C.** 40%
- D.** 80%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A product manager at a large, century-old appliance maker with offices in five countries proposes and then leads a new smart-home unit, funded by the company's budget and staffed with its engineers. She reports its progress to the executive team. What role is she playing?

- A.** Intrapreneur.
- B.** Entrepreneur.
- C.** Small-business owner.
- D.** Entrepreneur, because any new idea at work makes someone an entrepreneur.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A warehouse manager, ~~who has an engineering degree and a long commute~~, compares this month's order-accuracy rate of 94% with the 98% standard and schedules retraining for the pickers whose errors caused the gap. Which management function is she performing?

Target word: name the function **Decides:** Measure against a standard and correct.

A	Adjacent category	Retraining here is the corrective step in controlling.
B	Correct	Comparing results to standards and correcting deviations is controlling.
C	Confusion set	Organizing arranges people and resources, not performance checks.
D	Confusion set	Planning sets goals; she is checking against one already set.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A new clinic director decides the clinic will cut average patient wait times to 15 minutes by year-end and outlines the steps to get there. Which function is this?

Target word: name the function **Decides:** Setting goals and the path to them.

A	Confusion set	Leading would motivate staff to carry out the plan.
B	Correct	Setting objectives and deciding how to reach them is planning.
C	Confusion set	Organizing would assign staff and resources to the steps.
D	Inverted operation	Controlling comes after, comparing results to the goal.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A regional sales director ~~who has won three company awards~~ tells her team that the firm must shift from selling products to selling long-term service partnerships. She paints a picture of what that future looks like and rallies the team around it. ~~She keeps a plant on her desk.~~ What is she mainly doing?

Target word: management or leadership **Decides:** Setting new direction and inspiring change.

A	Correct	Vision and alignment toward change are leadership.
B	Confusion set	Managing would focus on budgets, schedules, and control.
C	Dropped element	Right answer, wrong reason; title does not define leadership.
D	Adjacent category	Controlling measures results; she is setting direction.

4. Answer C Concept 3

The marketing department of a national grocery chain, ~~after a well-attended offsite at a lake resort~~, writes a one-year plan to raise its store-brand share, including a quarterly campaign calendar tied to the CEO's five-year growth strategy. What level of plan is this?

Target word: classify the plan **Decides:** Department-level, medium term, translating strategy.

A	Adjacent category	Strategic plans are the CEO's organization-wide five-year plan.
B	Absolute language	Level depends on scope and time frame, not importance.
C	Correct	Departmental plans that carry out strategy over about a year are tactical.
D	Confusion set	Operational plans are daily or weekly task steps.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A furniture factory ~~with a new showroom~~ finds that 6% of its chairs have loose joints at final inspection. The plant manager, ~~who was hired from a rival last year~~, is considering options. Which option best reflects total quality management?

Target word: TQM response **Decides:** Build quality into the process.

A	Inverted operation	Relies on catching defects instead of preventing them.
B	Correct	Employee involvement and process improvement are core TQM.
C	Camouflage	The showroom does not affect defects.
D	Dropped element	Drops continuous improvement.

6. Answer D Concept 5

An engineer at a fast-growing aerospace firm ~~with a campus in Colorado~~ reports to the engineering department head for technical work and to a project manager for a satellite contract. ~~The firm recently opened a cafeteria.~~ What structure is this?

Target word: name the structure **Decides:** Two reporting lines: function and project.

A	Dropped element	Drops the project reporting line.
B	Confusion set	Divisional groups by product or region with one line of authority.
C	Adjacent category	Flat describes few levels, not dual reporting.
D	Correct	Dual reporting to a functional head and a project manager defines a matrix.

7. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A consumer-goods company reorganizes into three units — Beverages, Snacks, and Personal Care — each with its own marketing, operations, and finance staff. What structure is this?

Target word: name the structure **Decides:** Grouping by product line.

A	Inverted operation	Functional groups by specialty, the reverse of this.
B	Confusion set	No dual reporting is described.
C	Adjacent category	Network structures outsource major functions.
D	Correct	Self-contained units by product line are divisional.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A call center with 64 frontline agents, ~~a new phone system~~, and ~~a top customer satisfaction score~~ plans a hierarchy in which every manager has exactly 4 direct reports, up to a single director. How many managers, including the director, will it need?

Target word: number of managers **Decides:** $64 / 4 = 16$; $16 / 4 = 4$; $4 / 4 = 1$.

A	Confusion set	That is the count for a span of 8 ($8 + 1$).
B	Dropped element	Counts only the first level of supervisors.
C	Correct	$16 \text{ supervisors} + 4 \text{ managers} + 1 \text{ director} = 21$.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies 64 by 4 instead of dividing.

9. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A company wants fewer management layers without changing headcount. What should it do to span of control?

Target word: direction of change **Decides:** Wider spans produce flatter structures.

A	Inverted operation	Narrower spans add layers.
B	Adjacent category	A matrix adds reporting lines, not fewer layers.
C	Correct	More reports per manager means fewer managers and levels.
D	Absolute language	Extreme; widening spans reduces layers without removing oversight.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A regional bank ~~known for its community programs~~ hired 50 of 100 applicants from Group A and 12 of 40 applicants from Group B for teller jobs. The hiring manager says the test is neutral ~~and was bought from a respected vendor~~. Is there evidence of adverse impact under the four-fifths rule?

Target word: adverse impact or not **Decides:** Group B rate 30% / Group A rate 50% = 0.60.

A	Adjacent category	The rule uses the ratio of rates, not the point gap.
B	Camouflage	Adverse impact does not require intent or a biased-looking test.
C	Dropped element	Drops the applicant pool sizes; raw counts are not the test.
D	Correct	30% / 50% = 0.60 < 0.80, which signals adverse impact.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

A firm hires 60% of applicants from its highest-selected group. Under the four-fifths rule, what is the lowest selection rate another group can have without indicating adverse impact?

Target word: solve for threshold rate **Decides:** 60% × 0.80.

A	Correct	60% × 0.80 = 48%.
B	Inverted operation	60% / 0.80 divides instead of multiplying.
C	Adjacent category	Subtracts 20 points instead of taking 80% of the rate.
D	Wrong stem number	The ratio threshold, not a selection rate.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A product manager at a large, ~~century-old~~ appliance maker ~~with offices in five countries~~ proposes and then leads a new smart-home unit, funded by the company's budget and staffed with its engineers. She reports its progress to the executive team. What role is she playing?

Target word: name the role **Decides:** New venture inside an existing firm using its resources.

A	Correct	Pursuing a new venture inside a company with its resources is intrapreneurship.
B	Confusion set	Entrepreneurs start independent ventures and bear personal risk.
C	Adjacent category	She owns nothing; the company does.
D	Absolute language	The venture's ownership and risk determine the role.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The four management functions	Planning sets goals and how to reach them; organizing arranges people and resources; leading motivates and directs people; controlling measures performance against standards and corrects deviations.	Calling any review of results planning, or any people activity organizing.	The verb in the scenario: set goals, arrange, motivate, or measure and correct.
2	Management vs. leadership	Management produces order and consistency through plans, structure, and control; leadership produces change through vision, alignment, and inspiration; organizations need both.	Treating leadership as simply a senior management title.	Whether the person is keeping things running reliably or moving people toward something new.
3	Levels of planning	Strategic plans are long-term and organization-wide, set by top managers; tactical plans translate strategy for departments over the medium term; operational plans are short-term, specific steps for day-to-day work.	Classifying a plan by its importance instead of its scope and time frame.	Who writes the plan, how much of the organization it covers, and how far ahead it looks.
4	Total quality management	TQM builds quality into processes through customer focus, continuous improvement (such as Plan-Do-Check-Act), and employee involvement, rather than relying on inspection at the end.	Adding more final inspectors as the main fix for defects.	A defect problem and a choice between inspecting more or fixing the process.
5	Organizational structures	Functional structures group by specialty; divisional structures group by product, customer, or region; matrix structures combine both, so employees report to two managers.	Calling any structure with multiple teams a matrix.	How units are grouped and how many bosses each employee has.
6	Span of control	Span of control is the number of direct reports per manager; wider spans need fewer managers and produce flatter organizations, narrower spans produce taller ones.	Thinking a narrower span flattens the organization.	A headcount and a number of direct reports per manager.
7	Adverse impact and the four-fifths rule	A selection rate for any group below 80% of the rate for the group with the highest rate is evidence of adverse (disparate) impact, even without intent.	Comparing raw hire counts or the percentage-point gap instead of the ratio of rates.	Applicants and hires for two groups.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Entrepreneurship and intrapreneurship	Entrepreneurs start new ventures and bear personal financial risk; intrapreneurs pursue new ventures inside an existing organization using its resources.	Calling anyone who proposes a new idea at work an entrepreneur.	Whose money and organization carry the venture.

Course scope (public description): Principles of Management provides students with an introductory look at the discipline of management and its context within the business environment. Students of this course build on previously mastered competencies by taking a more in-depth look at management as a discipline and how it differs from leadership while further exploring the importance of communication within business. This course provides students with a business generalist overview in the areas of strategic planning, total quality, entrepreneurship, conflict and change, human resource management, diversity, and organizational structure.